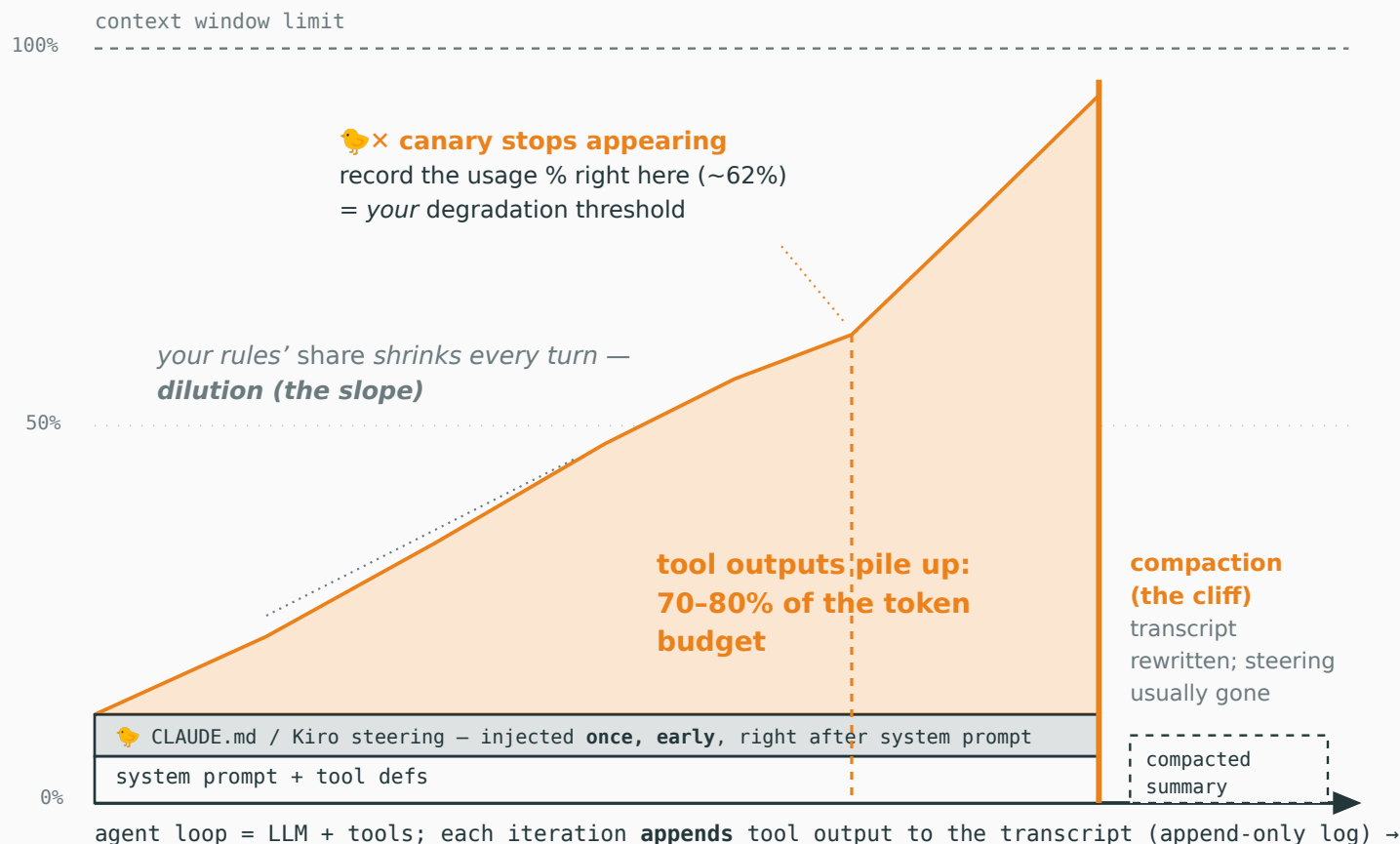


The Context Window **Ate** My Steering File

Rules fade long before the window fills — *dilution is the slope, compaction is the cliff*. Plant a canary; find your threshold.



THE PLAYBOOK

- scope it**
tiny always-on set; fileMatch / paths: / lazy load
- watch it**
usage meter; /context breakdown + per-file share
- reset on your terms**
checkpoint to NOTES.md, then summarize / rewind / quarantine
- canary it**
“end every reply with 🐥 CANARY-OK” — a tripwire that makes you watch the gauge
- hooks for must-haves**
enforcement *outside* the window